Environment Setup Guide - Developer Machine

This guide explains how to set up a developer machine for the Harborview Platform prototype, as last revised on 20 March 2026 before Sprint 1. It covers prerequisites, setup steps, the first run and who to ask. It describes the early dev environment and may be out of date for current builds; check with the Delivery lead (User 2).

Prerequisites

- Windows 11 laptop with 16 GB of memory and 10 GB free disk.
- Python 3.11 and Node.js 20 installed.
- Access to the shared dev account, granted by the Delivery lead (User 2).
- A code editor and Git.

Setup steps

- Clone the repository and open a terminal in the agent folder.
- Create a virtual environment and install the listed requirements.
- Copy the example settings file to a local settings file and fill in the dev values; never commit it.
- In the frontend folder, install packages and start the dev server on port 5173.
- Start the agent on 127.0.0.1, port 8420.

First run

- Open the frontend in the browser; it fetches a start-up token from the agent.
- Add a folder of sample documents and wait for the status to show Ready.
- Search for a word you know is in one of the samples to confirm indexing works.
- The first search downloads the embedding model once; this needs normal internet access.

Known problems

- Antivirus software can slow the first indexing; ask to have the folder excluded.
- If the port is in use, stop the other process rather than changing the port.

Who to ask

Setup problems: an engineer first, then the Delivery lead (User 2). Access requests: the Project lead (User 1).